resolve was tested in 2017 when the TTP spokesperson Ihsanullah Ihsan turned himself in. Ihsan is yet to be tried, with rumours that the army had given him amnesty. Families of the APS tragedy – which was labelled one of the worst attacks since Pakistan joined the war on terror – had to file a petition with the court demanding that Ihsanullah Ihsan be tried in a court of law or in a military court.

The war in Waziristan, FATA and PATA has also highlighted a problem of ethnic profiling. With the ongoing war innocent tribesmen from this region continue to be profiled by security agencies, often subject to target killings and 'disappearances'. A prominent victim of such target killing was Naqeebullah Mehsud, a twenty-seven-year-old shopkeeper and aspiring model who was accused of being a militant and killed through what the police often term 'encounter killings'. His murder by a well-known 'encounter specialist', Senior Superintendent Rao Anwar, unleashed outrage as news of his murder reached his Facebook fans who had been following Naqeebullah's modelling career (Ahmad 2018). This murder has resulted in an online campaign and spurred the PTM demanding justice and an end to ethnic profiling (Zahra-Malik 2018). They are also calling on the army to clear their tribal areas from landmines that have killed Pashtuns returning to their homes (Zahra-Malik 2018; Pashtun Long March 2018).

Terrorism in Pakistan also differs depending on where it takes place. Those living in Southern Punjab, Karachi, Balochistan or KP will experience violence perpetrated by different groups for a variety of reasons. While violence remains violence, no matter what justifications are given, young people did look at terrorism in different ways depending on where they had experienced it or where they came from.

South Punjab is one area where terrorism is linked to sectarian outfits. Hussain (2018) highlights how 'sectarian organizations and jihadi groups in Pakistan' had 'formed a nexus with the TTP and supported each other' (2018, p. 345). The state has patronized such militant groups for the distinct purpose of using these groups in Kashmir to fight against the Indian forces, or for its strategic interests in Afghanistan. Groups such as Jaish-e-Mohammed (responsible for the 2 January 2016 attack on India's Pathankot airbase, and more recently claimed responsibility for the attack in Pulwama on 14 February 2019) and the sectarian Lashkhar-e-Jhangvi (LeJ) have a strong presence. The military targets LeJ; however, the anti-India Jaish continues largely undisturbed.

LeJ's roots lie in Pakistan's first major radical anti-Shia Deobandi group SSP. SSP had emerged under Zia and was supported by Saudi Arabia to counter the